

Basics on Probability

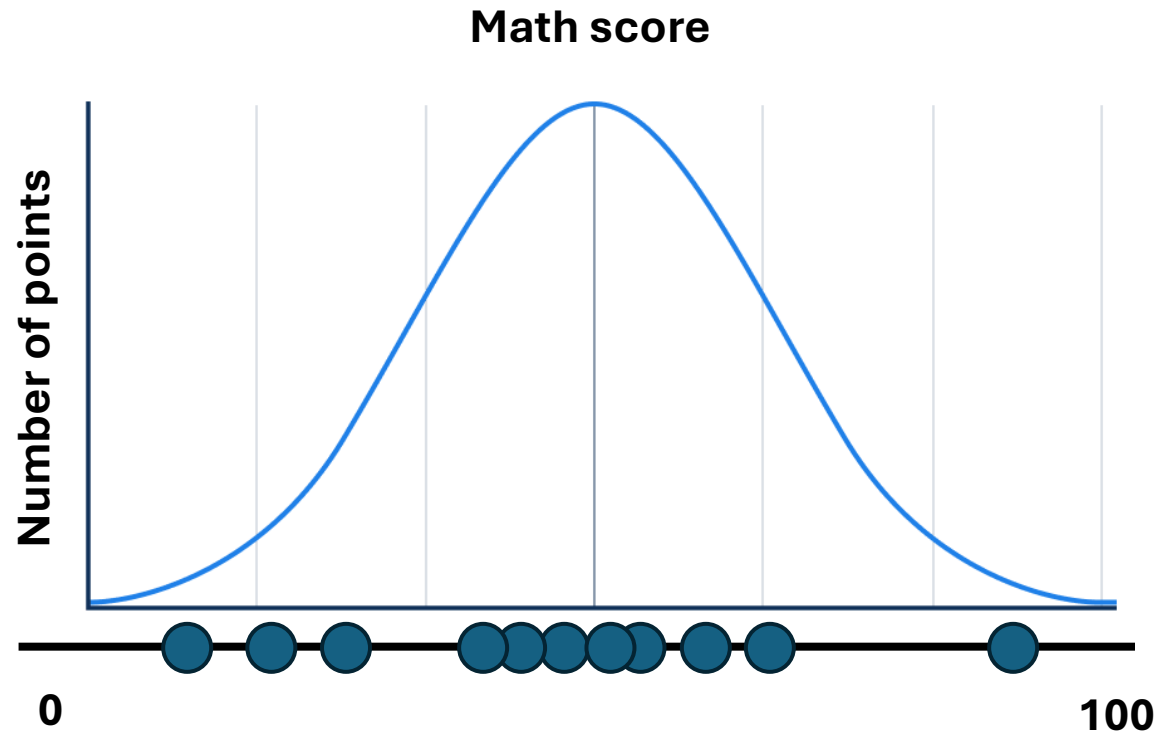
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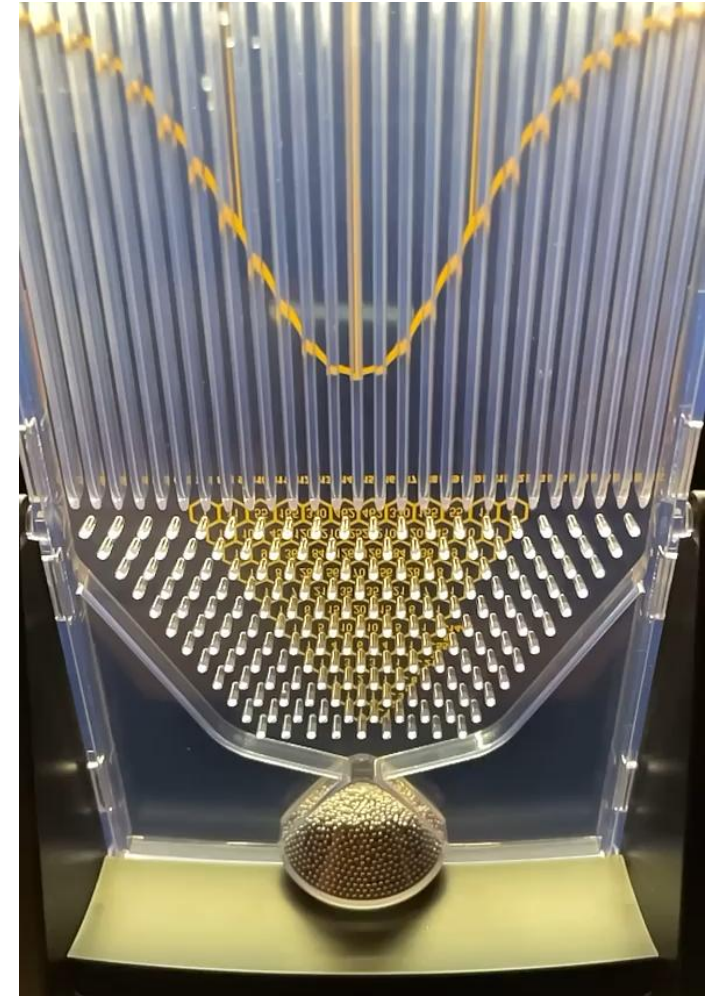
- Many contents are inspired from CS 285 at UC Berkeley
<https://www.youtube.com/@rail7462/courses>
- Check https://github.com/bear-research-lab/Class_AIR/tree/main/Week3 for extra codes.

Basics of Probability and Machine Learning

B0. Probability density function

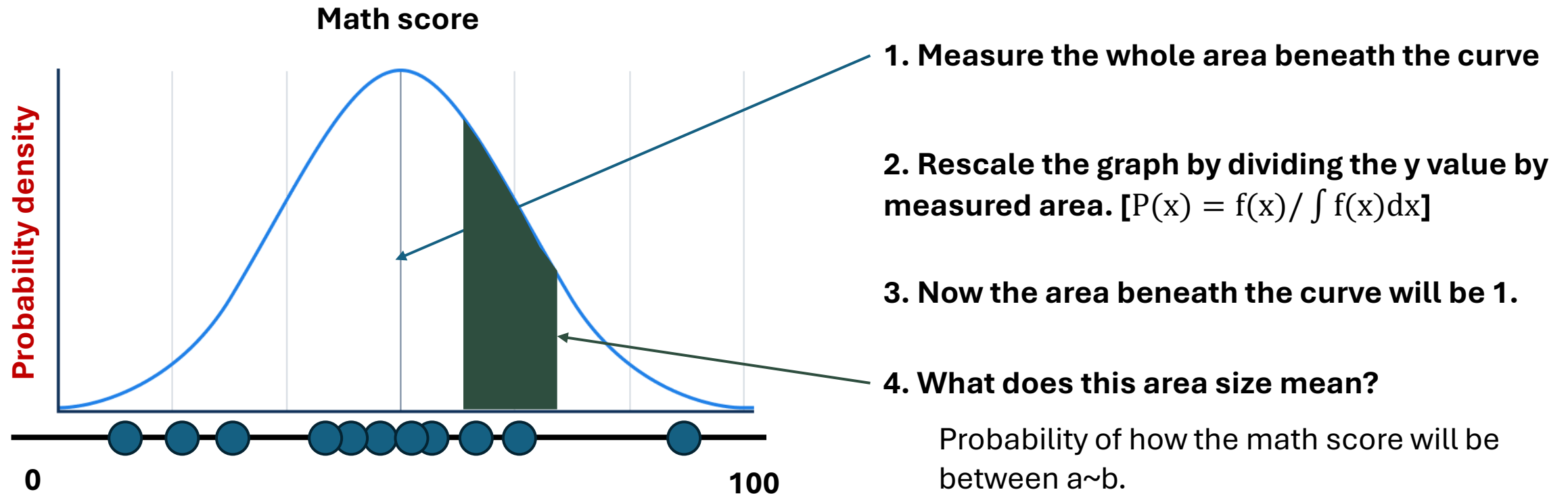


➤ Y axis means how many data will be there in this phenomena.



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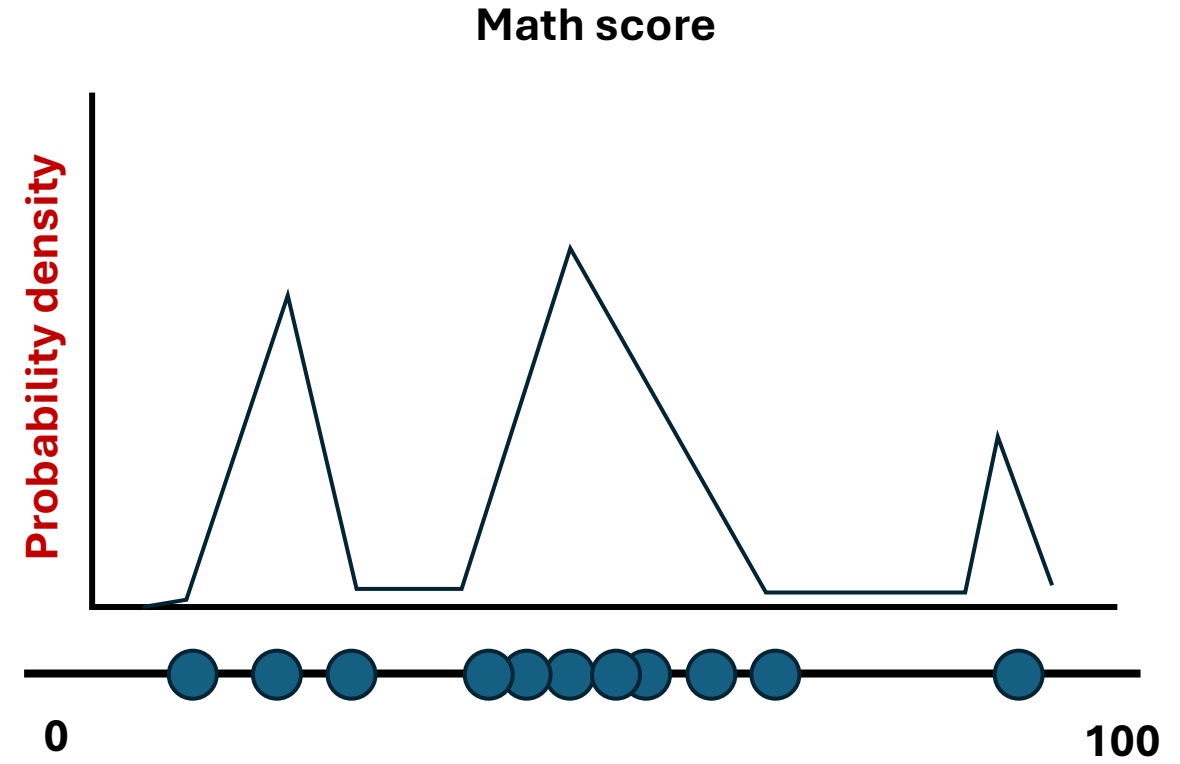
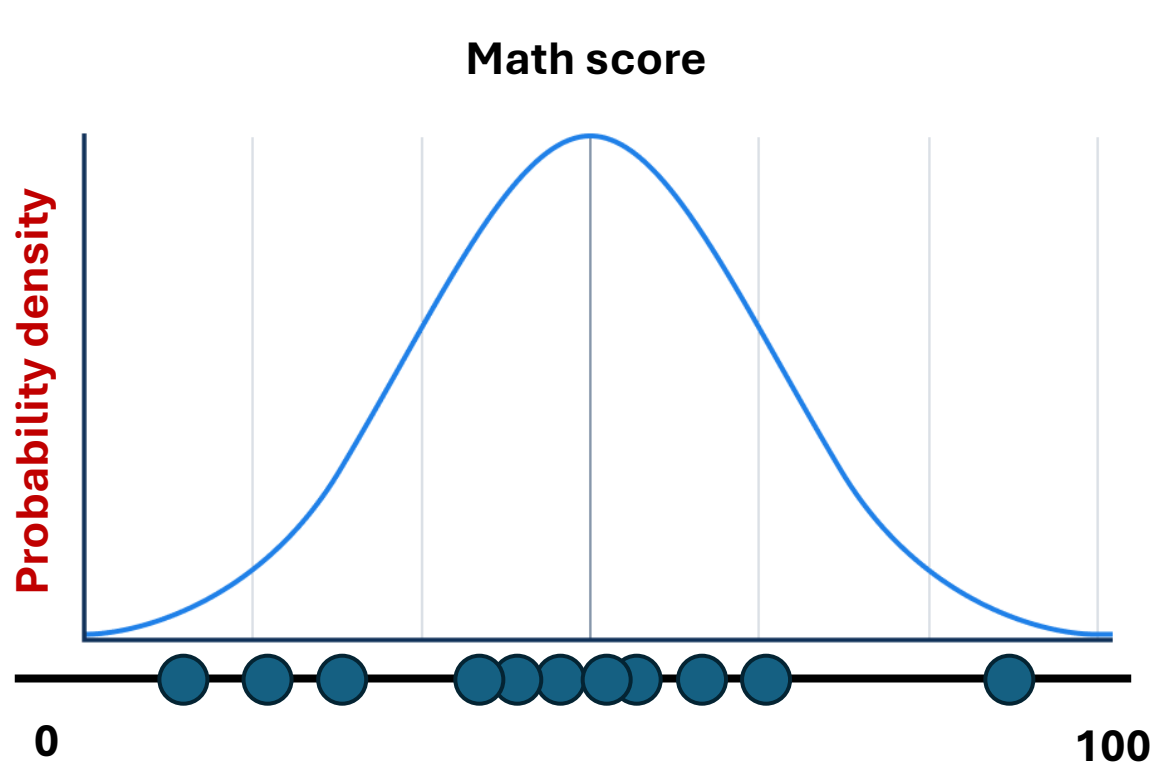
B0. Probability density function – Definition and usage



- The function that represents this graph is called: “probability density function (PDF)”.
- The area beneath the curve defines the probability.

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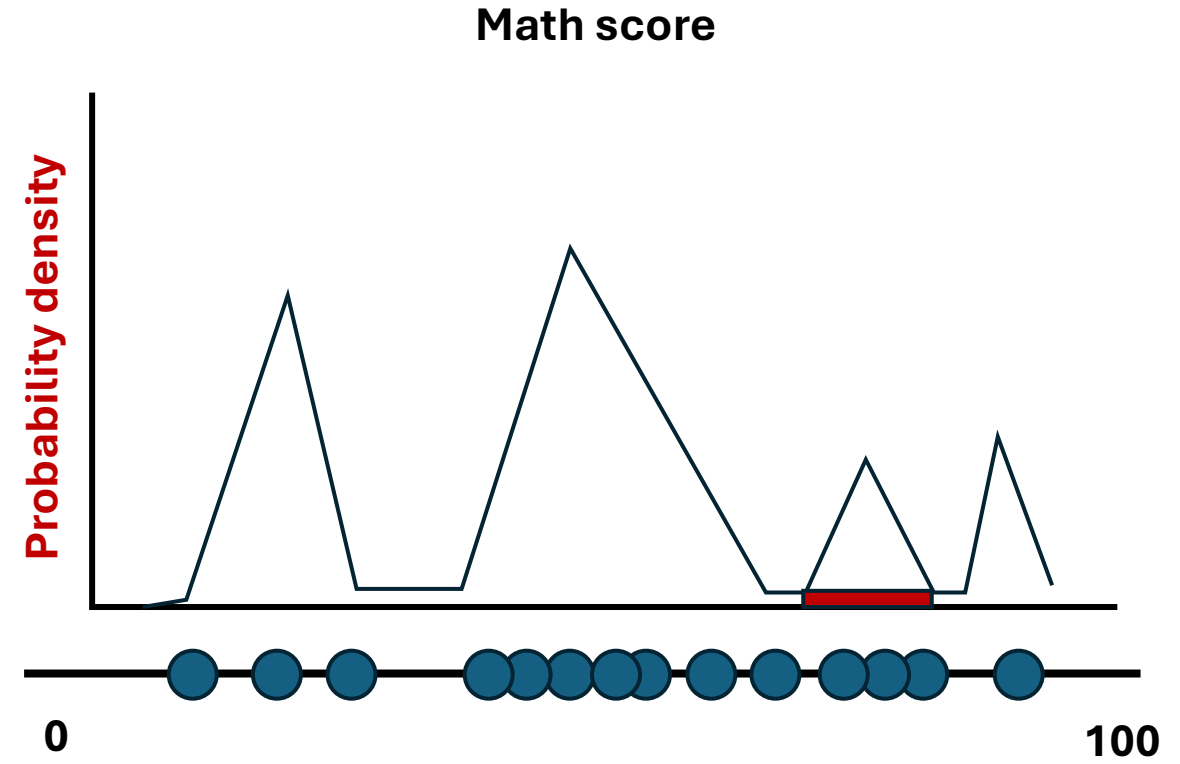
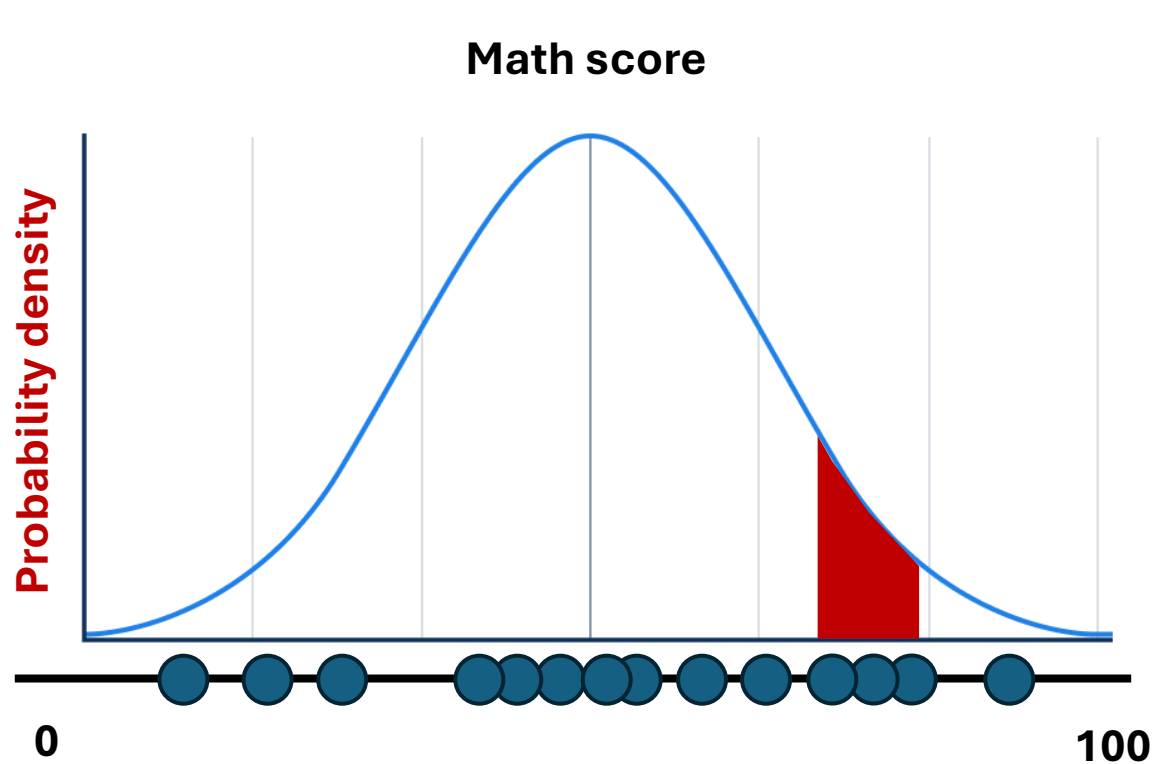
B0. Probability density function



➤ Which distribution (shape) is better to represent our math score data?

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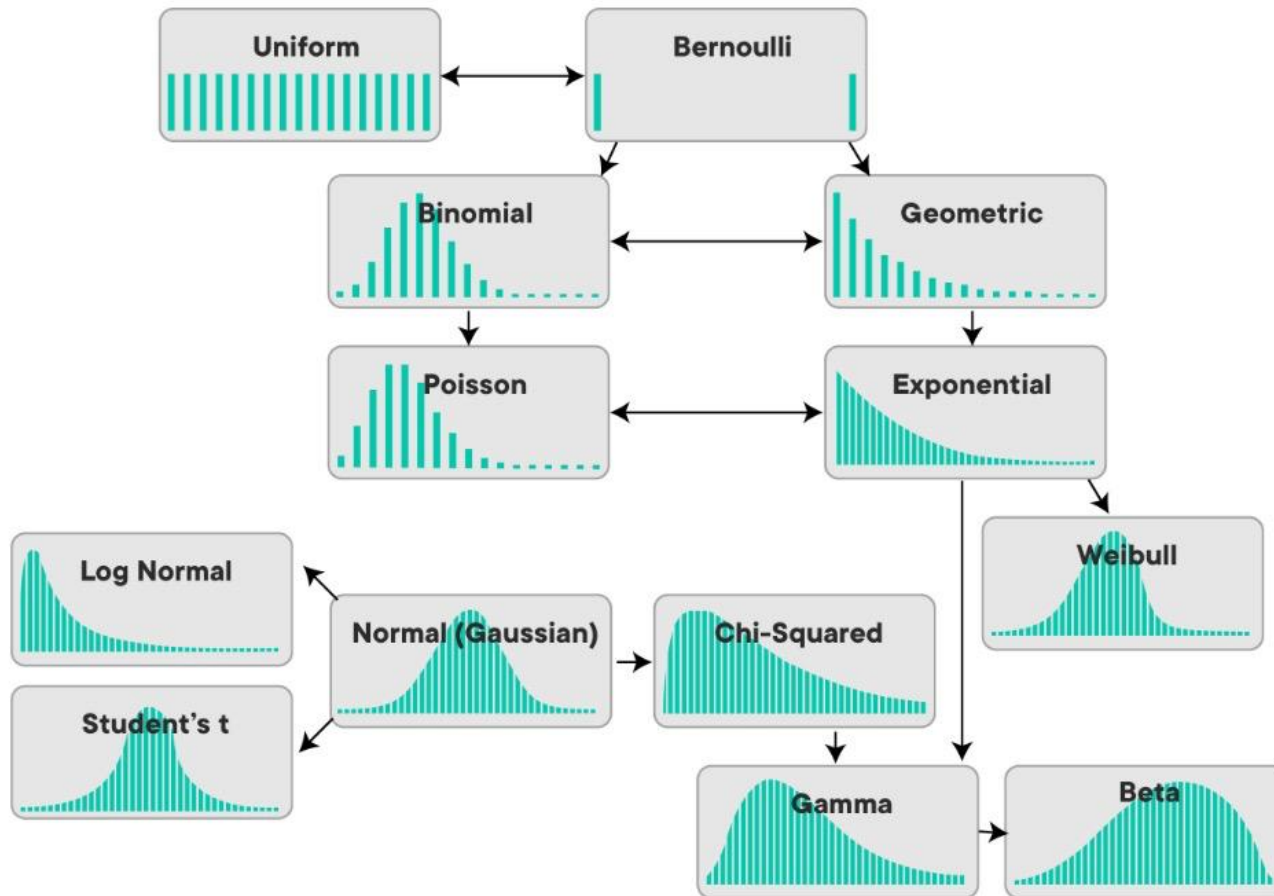
B0. Probability density function



- What is the probability of students to get score between 75~90?
- The left distribution assigns higher probability mass to the observed data range.

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B0. Probability density function – We need to choose an “appropriate” distribution



- There exists diverse distributions that can represent Probability density function (PDF).
- In most of cases (in our class) will deal with **normal distribution**.
- We need to find appropriate mean and standard deviation to use normal distribution.

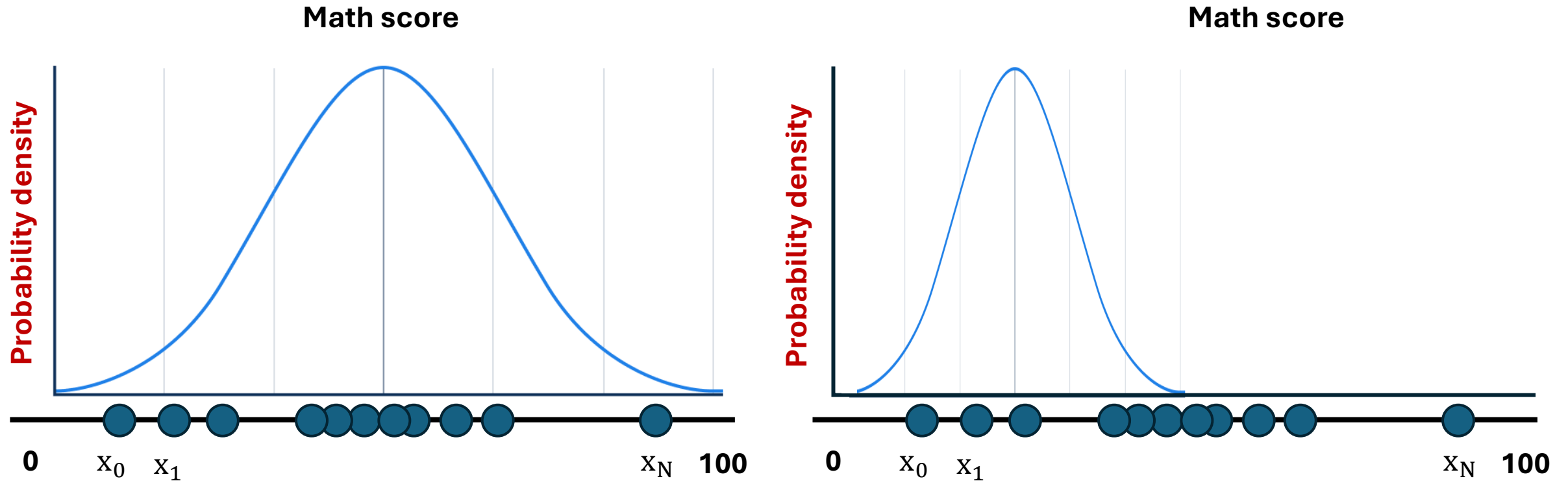
$$y = \frac{1}{\sigma\sqrt{2\pi}} e^{-\frac{(x - \mu)^2}{2\sigma^2}}$$

μ = Mean

σ = Standard Deviation

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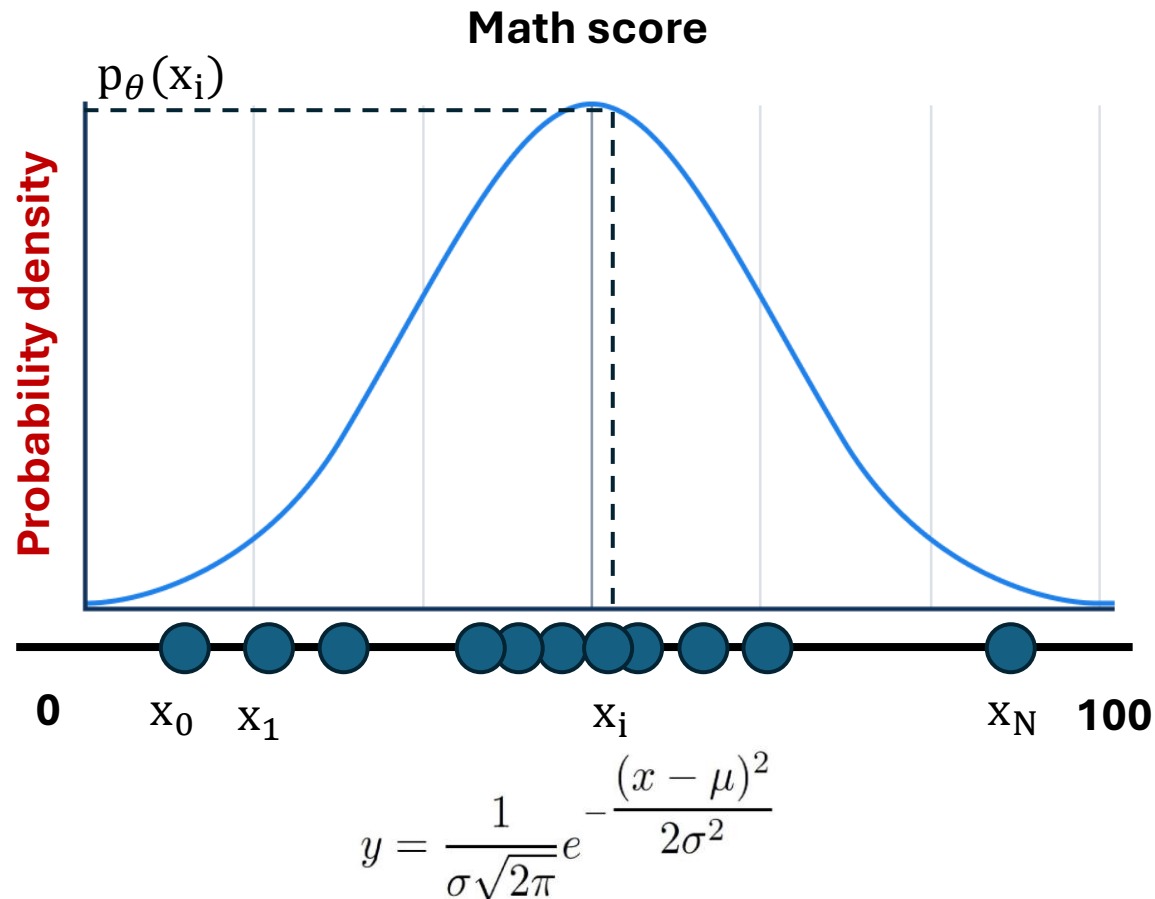
B0. Parameterizing the distribution using Maximum Likelihood



➤ Which distribution (left or right) is “likelihood” to represent the observed data?

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B0. Parameterizing the distribution using Maximum (log)Likelihood Estimation (MLE)



➤ Likelihood function can be defined as:

$$L^*(\theta) = \prod_{i=1}^N p_{\theta}(x_i)$$
$$\theta^* = \operatorname{argmax} L^*(\theta)$$

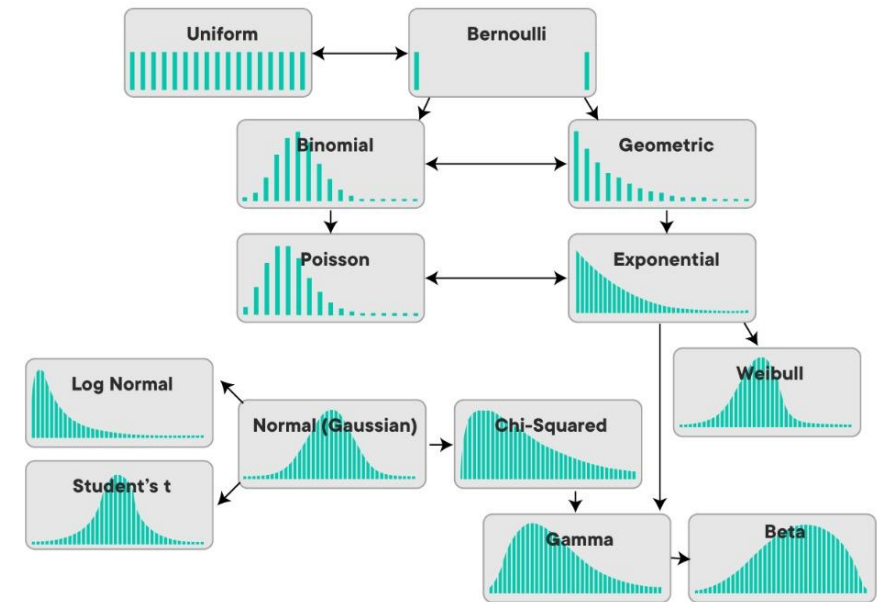
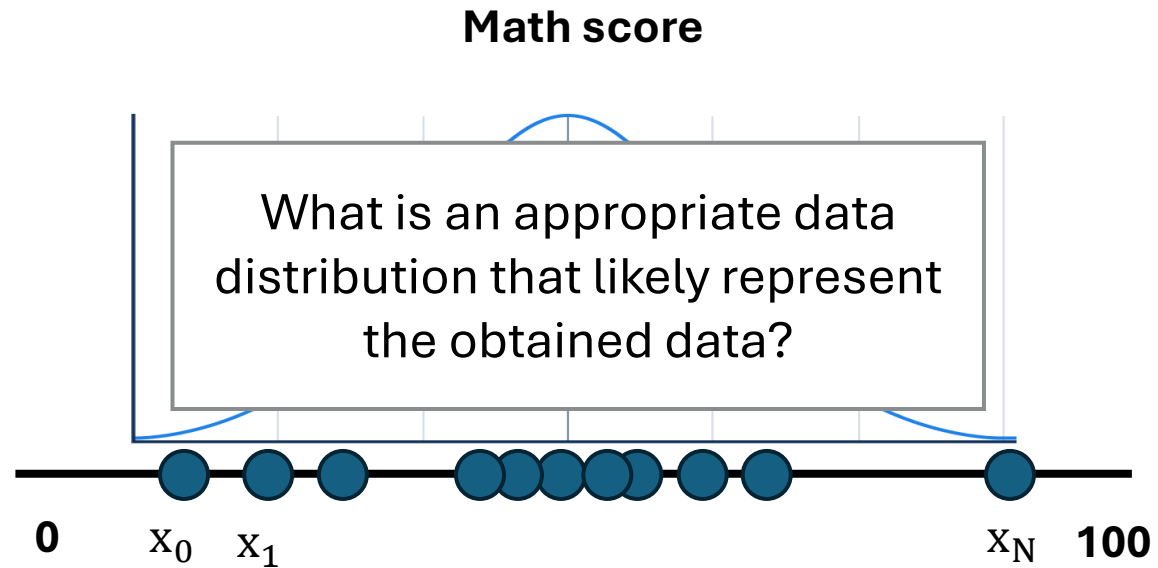
➤ However, $L^*(\theta)$ could be too small because $p_{\theta}(x_i)$ are smaller than 1. Instead, we use:

$$L(\theta) = \log\left(\prod_{i=1}^N p_{\theta}(x_i)\right) = \sum \log(p_{\theta}(x_i))$$
$$\theta^* = \operatorname{argmax} L(\theta)$$

➤ Note that, $\log(f(x))$ and $f(x)$ is Monotonic Increasing.

Summary of Basics of Probability and Machine Learning

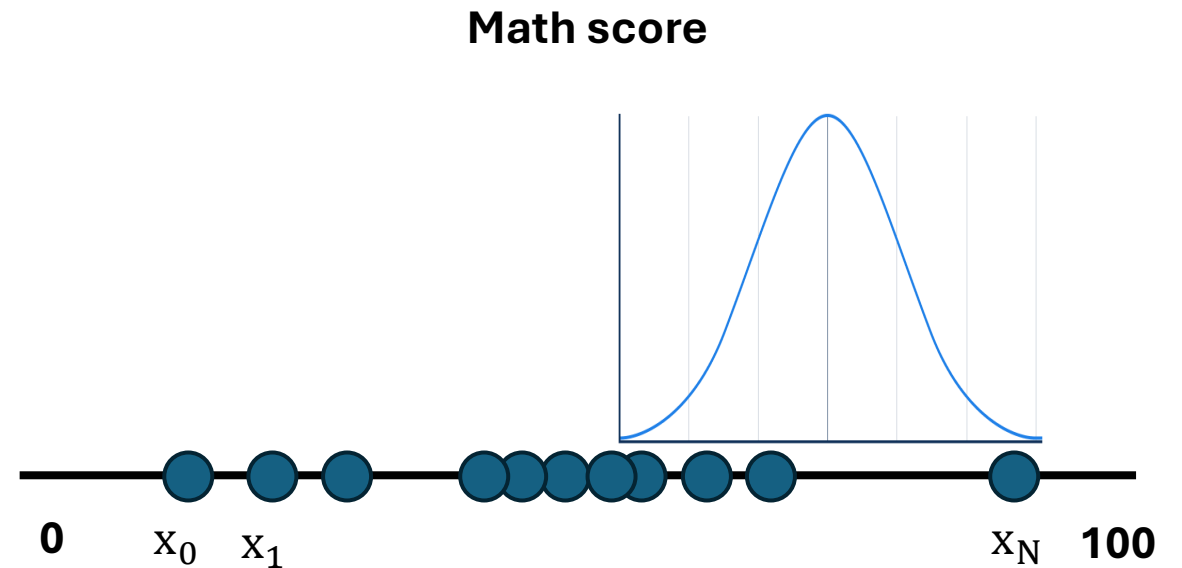
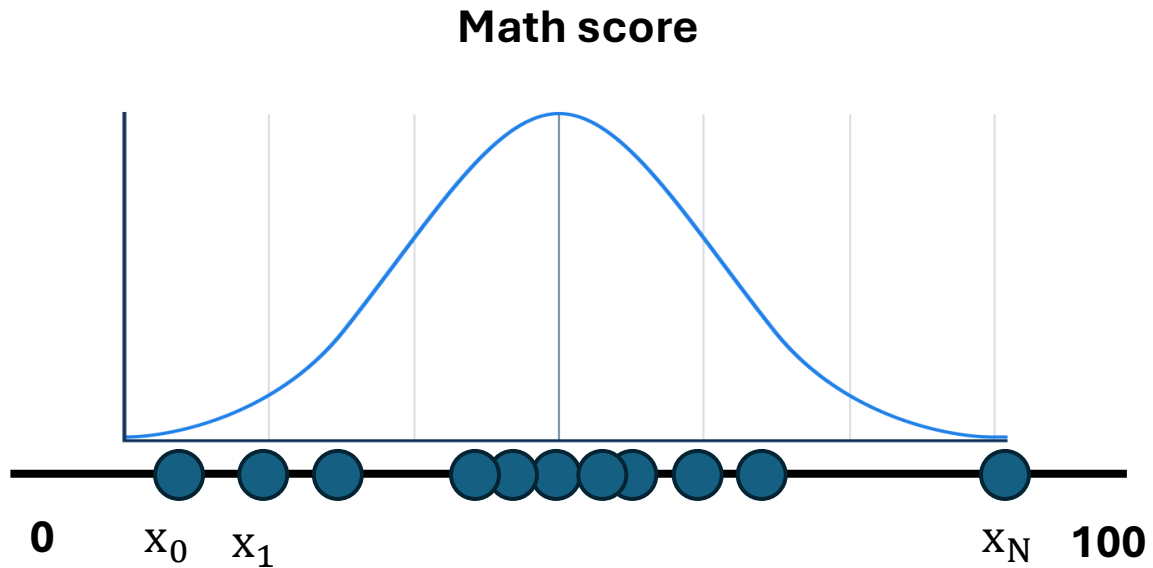
Key Takeaway: We can use MLE to parameterize obtained data distribution



- Step1: Find appropriate probability density function (PDF) for obtained data distribution- we mostly use normal distribution.

Summary of Basics of Probability and Machine Learning

Key Takeaway: We can use MLE to parameterize obtained data distribution



➤ Step2: Find appropriate parameter that fit chosen PDF to the data distribution.

- This is done by Maximum Loglikelihood Estimation (MLE) method
- In normal distribution we find mean and variance.

$$L(\theta) = \sum \log(p_{\theta}(x_i))$$

$$\theta^* = \operatorname{argmax} L(\theta)$$

Basics of Probability and Machine Learning

B1. Mathematical Expression of the ML model

- Imagine familiar equation: $y = f_{\theta}(x)$. This is a deterministic relationship between x and y . θ means that the equation is modelled with parameter θ . For example, we can imagine $y = \theta x + b$
- However, in many cases of ML, x and y are NOT a single vector or scalar. Instead, they are “sampled” from a data distribution $p_{\text{data}}(x, y)$. In this case, we should model conditional distribution $p(y|x)$ and then sample y from it:

$$y \sim p_{\theta}(y|x).$$



**Imagine y as taste x as distribution of apples.
There are many red apples but less yellow, green apples.**



Basics of Probability and Machine Learning

B2. Bayes' rule

➤ In ML model that has $p_{\theta}(y|x)$ form, it is useful to know Bayes' rule:

$$p(y | x) = \frac{p(x, y)}{p(x)} = \frac{p(x | y) p(y)}{p(x)}$$

➤ $p(y|x)$: Given X , what is the probability of y

➤ $p(x, y)$: Joint probability of x and y

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B3. Joint probability and its marginalization

➤ Problem definition: Driving a car from home to school.

- Variables could be {x: traffic level represented in average speed, y: time of day}.



Intuition: if we have 10 different conditions affecting the phenomena (time, speed, rain, health, etc). We can remove the effect of conditions by marginalizing them.

- $p(x = 10, y = 10)$ will have high value.
- $p(x = 2, y = 10)$ will have low value.

➤ What should we do if we want to know $p(x)$ that doesn't care about time of day?

$$p(x) = \int p(x, y) dy$$

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B4. Marginalization of conditional probability

➤ Problem definition: Driving a car from home to school in the rain.

- Variables could be {x: amount of rain fall, y: departure time}.
- If I want to know about probability of being late, we can write down this by:
$$p(l|x, y)$$
- Now, we want to know $p(l|y)$ which represents probability of being late conditioned on departure time.
 - This means, we now don't care about the rain. We want to know about **probability of being late** without being affected by rain fall.
- We can account for all rain conditions by marginalizing the density function over x

$$p(l|y) = \int p(l|x, y)p(x|y)dx$$



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B5. Expectation of function under certain probability

➤ Assume $x \sim p(x)$. Then we can obtain expectation of function $f(x)$ as:

$$\mathbb{E}_{p(\mathbf{x})}[f(\mathbf{x})] = \int f(\mathbf{x}) p(\mathbf{x}) d\mathbf{x}.$$

➤ In ML, this expression is used frequently when the model deals with the distribution – i.e., $x \sim p_{\text{data}}(x)$. Expectation can be understood as the average of $f(x)$ under distribution $p_{\text{data}}(x)$.

Example:

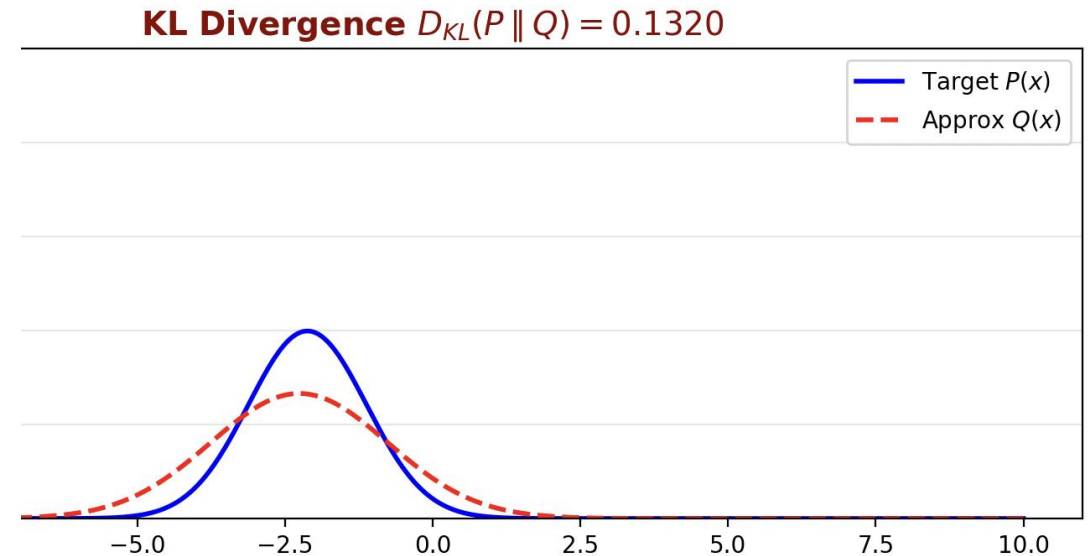
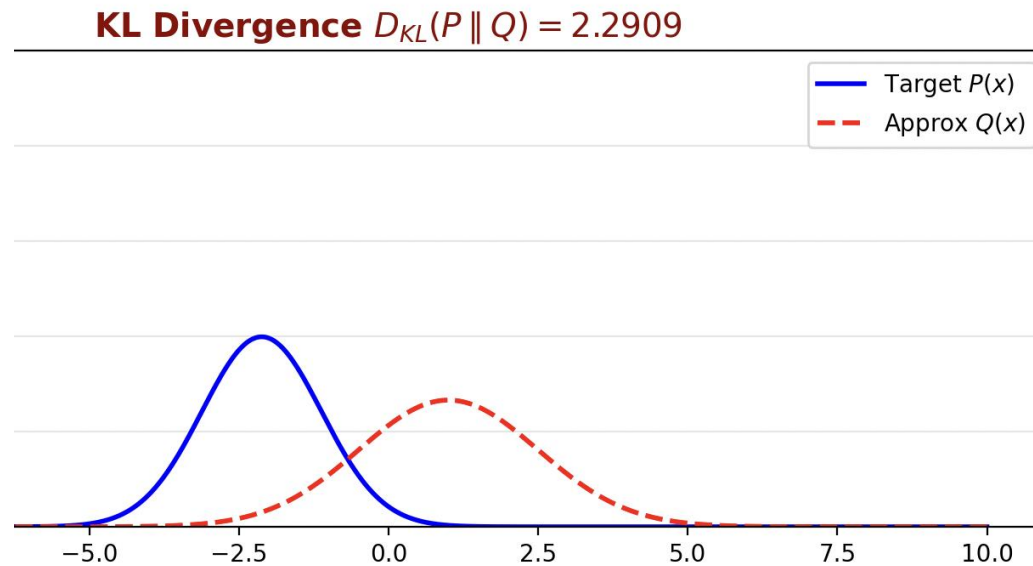
- We have 10 apples. 60% of apples are red, 10% of apples are yellow, and 30% of apples are green.
- Sweetness of red apples is 10, yellow apples have 8 sweetness, and green apples have 6.
- What is the expected sweetness?
 - $0.6 \cdot 10 + 0.1 \cdot 8 + 0.3 \cdot 6 = 7.6$



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B6. KL(Kullback-Leibler) divergence

➤ Assume we want to know the difference between two distribution. See two images below:



➤ We can measure the difference between two distributions by using KL divergence.

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B6. KL(Kullback-Leibler) divergence

➤ Assume we have two probability density function $P(x)$ and $Q(x)$.

➤ Then, KL divergence $D_{\text{KL}}(P \parallel Q)$ can be defined as

$$\sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} P(x) \log \frac{P(x)}{Q(x)}$$

➤ This is equivalent to:

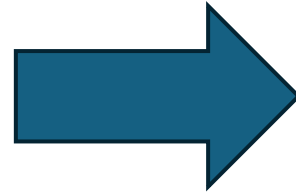
$$D_{\text{KL}}(P \parallel Q) = \left(- \sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} P(x) \log Q(x) \right) - \left(- \sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} P(x) \log P(x) \right)$$

To understand KL divergence...
We should understand a concept of Entropy.

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B7. Entropy

- Assume we bought 5 lottery tickets. This lottery has 1% of chance to get 1 billion won (10억), 50% chance to get 1000won, and 49% chance to get 0won.



Surprisingly, all the tickets gave me 1 billion won !!

The amount of surprise is related to the probability.

- To express our surprise in the equation, we can imagine

$$Q^*(p) = 1/p \text{ where, } p \text{ is the probability}$$

- However, this could be extremely small in some cases. For the above case it will be:

$$Q^*(p) = 10^2 * 10^2 * 10^2 * 10^2 * 10^2$$

- To solve this issue, easy way is to use “log”:

$$Q^{\log \text{case}}(p) = \log_{10} (1/p) = 2 + 2 + 2 + 2 + 2$$

We used $\log_{10}$ for easier computation, but we can use other such as 10 or 2 or e.

Basics of Probability and Machine Learning

B7. Entropy

- Assume we bought 5 lottery tickets. 1000won, and 49% chance to get 0won



Example:

- We have 10 apples. 60% of apples are red, 10% of apples are yellow, and 30% of apples are green.
- Sweetness of red apples is 10, yellow apples have 8 sweetness, and green apples have 6.
- What is the expected sweetness?
 - $0.6 \times 10 + 0.1 \times 8 + 0.3 \times 6 = 7.6$

- To solve this issue, easy way is to use “log”:

$$Q^{\text{logcase}}(p) = \log(1/p) = 2 + 2 + 2 + \log_{10}(2) + \log_{10}(100/49)$$

- Shouldn't we also think about how likely it will happen (Expectation)?

$$Q(p) = \sum p * \log(1/p) = 0.01 * 2 + 0.01 * 2 + 0.01 * 2 + 0.5 * \log_{10}(2) + 0.49 * \log_{10}(100/49)$$

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B7. Entropy

- Assume we bought 5 lottery tickets. 1000won, and 49% chance to get 0won



Example:

- We have 10 apples. 60% of apples are red, 10% of apples are yellow, and 30% of apples are green.
- Sweetness of red apples is 10, yellow apples have 8 sweetness, and green apples have 6.
- What is the expected sweetness?
 - $0.6 \times 10 + 0.1 \times 8 + 0.3 \times 6 = 7.6$

- Interpreting the entropy:

$$Q_p(p) = \sum p * \log(1/p) = E_p[-\log(p(x))]$$

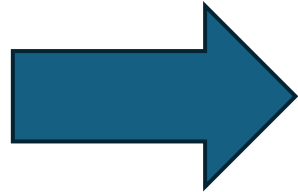
- In continuous phenomena we can express entropy as:

$$Q_p(p) = E_p(-\log(p)) = \int -p(x)\log(p(x))dx$$

Understanding KL divergence from the concept of entropy

Connecting Entropy with KL divergence

- Assume we bought 5 lottery tickets. This lottery has 1% of chance to get 1 billion won (10억), 50% chance to get 1000won, and 49% chance to get 0won.



Now, 3 tickets got 1 billion won, 1 ticket got 1000 won, and 1 ticket got 0won.

How about in this case?

- The fact was... that, due to the printing issue, the lottery had 60% of chance to get 1 billion won and 20% chance to get 1000 won, and 20% chance to get 0 won!!
- This will provide more surprise, so that the entropy could be larger.
- We use this increase of surprise as a difference of two distribution.

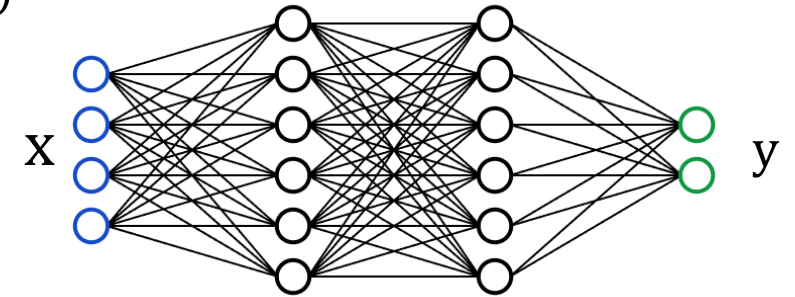
$$D_{\text{KL}}(P \parallel Q) = \left(- \sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} P(x) \log Q(x) \right) - \left(- \sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} P(x) \log P(x) \right)$$

Entropy of mistake case Entropy of original case

Overview on machine learning

➤ Supervised learning

- Given $D = \{(x_i, y_i)\}$, find parameter θ that satisfies $y_i \approx f_\theta(x_i)$ or $f_\theta(y_i|x_i)$
- Requires I.I.D (Independent, Identically Distributed) assumption.
 - Independent assumption: $(x_i, y_i) \perp (x_j, y_j) \forall i \neq j$
 - Identically Distributed assumption: $(x_{train}, y_{train}), (x_{test}, y_{test}) \sim p(x, y)$
- Ground truth assumption: training labels y_{train} are the ground-truth outputs.



➤ Reinforcement Learning

- Train a policy using data collected through interaction with the environment.
- I.I.D assumption is violated.
- Ground truth assumption is also violated.

➤ Unsupervised learning

- Given $D = \{x_i\}$, find parameter θ that represents hidden structure in the data.
- I.I.D assumption: typically assumed.